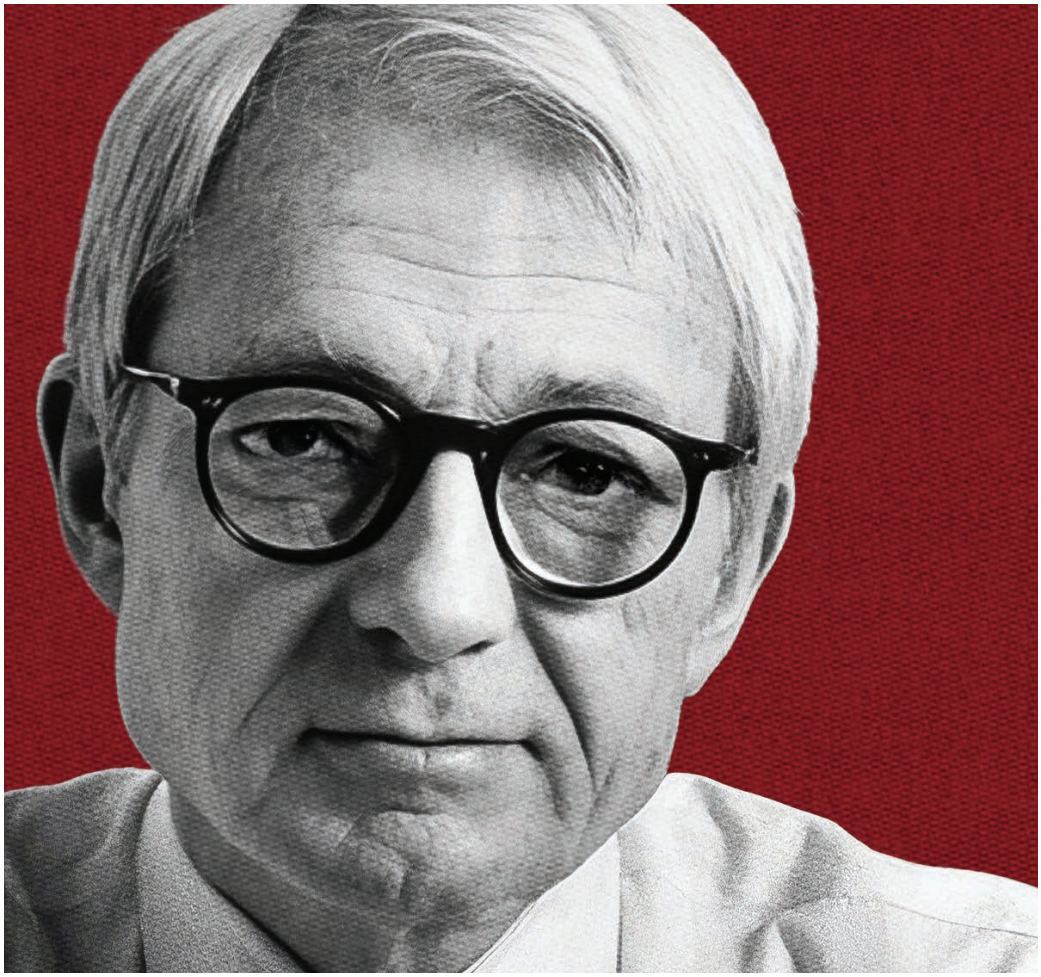


Photo by Arnold Newman

# HELMUT KRONE

was born in New York in 1925, shortly after his parents had emigrated from Germany. As a young man, he was prompted to enter print advertising when he saw the work of Paul Rand. He later joined DDB as an art director. Krone was described by his colleagues as "a complex kraut" and "a fidgety perfectionist who worked with deadly Teutonic patience". The simple layouts he designed didn't betray the countless hours agonising over tiny details. DDB was actually already promoting the Volkswagen for a local car dealer. Krone was working on that campaign, so it was only natural that he was given the main account. He also personally owned a Volkswagen. Like all the teams at DDB, Krone (the art director) worked alongside a copywriter, in this case a Jewish man who wasn't bothered with the Nazi connections.

Julian Koenig was born in 1921, also in New York City. He had an on-off relationship with advertising, feeling frustrated at the lack of creativity he was permitted to express in his writing. After a brief stint as a professional horse better, he joined DDB as a copywriter in 1958. Working with Helmut Krone was apparently a challenge. Krone was unhappy with the honest approach Bernbach wanted to take. He initially wanted to present the car the way the other agencies had intended to — make the car as American as possible. Krone was also uncomfortable with the idea of selling"the Führer's car".

It was when the client, advertising manager Helmut Schmitz read Koenig's copy that he noticed a small line. The copy went "maybe we got so big because we thought small". Schmitz pointed at "think small" and said that was to be the headline. Koenig was pleased with this — his original headline had actually been "Think Small" but he'd been talked out of it by Krone who had wanted "Willkommen".

The art director was very unhappy with this development, and it took an intervention by Bernbach to persuade him to come up with some layouts. After much experimentation, Krone settled on a traditional ad layout, with an untraditional image. The headline and three column body was a traditional format used in a lot of advertising — Krone jokingly called it "The Olgivy Layout", Olgivy being an agency